

Xiutian Zhao

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🔍 [Google Scholar](#) | 🌐 <https://github.com/xiutian>

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EDUCATION

Johns Hopkins University

Baltimore, MD

Ph.D. student, Electrical and Computer Engineering

2025 - 2029 (*expected*)

- Advisor: [Berrak Sisman](#)
- Affiliation: [Center for Language and Speech Processing](#)
[Data Science and AI Institute](#)

University of Edinburgh

Edinburgh, UK

MSc., Speech and Language Processing, with Distinction

2024 - 2025

- Advisor: [Ivan Titov](#)
- Dissertation: *Culture-Specific Neurons in Vision–Language Models: Identification, Causal Ablations, and Layer-wise Localization.*

Columbia University

New York, NY

M.S., Applied Statistics

2017 – 2019

Fordham University

New York, NY

B.A., Interdisciplinary Mathematics & Economics

2014 - 2017

PREPRINTS

- [3] [Discovering and Causally Validating Emotion-Sensitive Neurons in Large Audio-Language Models](#)
Xiutian Zhao, Björn Schuller, Berrak Sisman
Preprint on arXiv, under review
- [2] [Unwrapping Circularity: Can Transformers Learn Languages with Circular Schemes?](#)
Xiutian Zhao, Rafi Aulia, Siying Chen, Xiulin Yang
Presented at *ACL 2025 Student Research Workshop*
- [1] [A Survey on Hallucination in Large Vision-Language Models](#)
Hanchao Liu, Wenyuan Xue, Yifei Chen, Dapeng Chen, **Xiutian Zhao**, Ke Wang, Liping Hou, Rongjun Li, Wei Peng
Preprint on arXiv

PUBLICATIONS

- [9] [Finding Culture-Sensitive Neurons in Vision-Language Models](#)
Xiutian Zhao, Rochelle Choenni, Rohit Saxena, Ivan Titov
To appear in *EACL 2026*, **oral presentation**
- [8] [An Electoral Approach to Diversify LLM-based Multi-Agent Collective Decision-Making](#)
Xiutian Zhao, Ke Wang, Yanghui Li, Wei Peng
EMNLP 2024, also presented at *ICML 2024 HAS Workshop*
- [7] [Watch Every Step! LLM Agent Learning via Iterative Step-level Process Refinement](#)
Weimin Xiong, Yifan Song, **Xiutian Zhao**, Wenhao Wu, Xun Wang, Ke Wang, Cheng Li, Wei Peng, Sujian Li
EMNLP 2024
- [6] [AgentBank: Towards Generalized LLM Agents via Fine-Tuning on 50000+ Interaction Trajectories](#)
Yifan Song, Weimin Xiong, **Xiutian Zhao**, Dawei Zhu, Wenhao Wu, Ke Wang, Cheng Li, Wei

Peng, Sujian Li
EMNLP 2024

- [5] [Measuring the Inconsistency of Large Language Models in Preferential Ranking](#)
Xiutian Zhao, Ke Wang, Yanghui Li, Wei Peng
ACL 2024 KnowLLM Workshop oral presentation
- [4] [Learning from Failure: Improving Meeting Summarization without Good Samples](#)
Ke Wang, Xiutian Zhao, Wei Peng
AAAI 2024
- [3] [ORCHID: A Chinese Debate Corpus for Target-Independent Stance Detection and Argumentative Dialogue Summarization](#)
Xiutian Zhao, Ke Wang, Wei Peng
EMNLP 2023
- [2] [PROSE: A Pronoun Omission Solution for Chinese-English Spoken Language Translation](#)
Ke Wang, Xiutian Zhao, Yanghui Li, Wei Peng
EMNLP 2023
- [1] [M³Seg: A Maximum-Minimum Mutual Information Paradigm for Unsupervised Topic Segmentation in ASR Transcripts](#)
Ke Wang, Xiutian Zhao, Yanghui Li, Wei Peng
EMNLP 2023

WORK EXPERIENCE	Research Assistant Peking University–Huawei Co-Laboratory	2023 - 2024
	• Conducted research projects in language model-based agents.	
	Research Assistant Huawei Technologies	2020 - 2024
	• Conducted research projects in machine translation, automatic summarization.	

AWARDS AND HONORS	• Relocation Grant , Johns Hopkins University, \$2,500	2025
	• The Edinburgh Award , School of Informatics: Tutoring, University of Edinburgh	2025
	• Psi Chi , Columbia University	2018

TEACHING	Informatics Tutor: Informatics Tutoring Scheme	2024 - 2025
	A project that supports high school students on Computer Science and Maths, with a priority for schools in disadvantaged areas of Scotland.	

ACADEMIC SERVICES	Organizing Committee: MASC-SLL 2026	2026
	Mid-Atlantic Student Colloquium in Speech, Language and Learning.	
	Organizing Committee: Linguistic Circle	2024 - 2025
	A flagship seminar series organized by the Linguistics and English Language Department of the University of Edinburgh.	
	Student Volunteer: EMNLP 2024	2024
	EACL 2026	2026
	Reviewer for: ACL Rolling Review	2024, 2025, 2026
	NeurIPS	2025
	IEEE Transactions on Affective Computing	2025, 2026
AAAI	2025	
COLM	2025	
EACL, Student Research Workshop	2025	
ACL, the 11th Workshop on Argument Mining	2024	

SKILLS	Languages: English, Mandarin Chinese, Japanese	
	Programming: Python, R, $\LaTeX$	
	Misc: Landscape photography, swimming, stargazing	
CERTIFICATION	Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate <i>Google</i>	2022
	The 4th Annual Institute in Statistics for Big Data <i>University of Washington</i>	2018
ACTIVITIES	International Ambassador: Fordham University Rose Hill Society	2015-2017
	Vice-President: Fudan University Film Association	2013-2014